INGLÉS · NIVEL A1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Basic English connectors A1: and, but, or, because and so

Name the relationship between the two ideas before choosing the connector. Then check whether the second clause adds, contrasts, offers an alternative, gives a reason or presents a result.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Connect two complete A1 ideas with the connector that preserves their logical relationship.

MODELO

I walk because the school is near, so I arrive early.

Al terminar podrás

1. Add information with and
2. Contrast with but
3. Offer alternatives with or
4. Distinguish reason because from result so

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve las seis etapas y corrige al final. Vuelve al modelo para justificar cada decisión.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

La idea esencial

Five basic connectors let A1 learners add, contrast, choose, explain a reason and state a result. The lesson makes the logical direction visible so because and so are not treated as interchangeable translations.

Build the central contrast

The lesson is organised around a small set of choices that produce different meanings. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Addition	Nora studies English and French.	And adds a second item.
Contrast	The café is small, but it is comfortable.	But contrasts size and comfort.
Choice	Do you want tea or coffee?	Or presents alternatives.

Read the sentence purpose

A statement, question, negative, offer or answer can activate a different form. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Reason	I walk because the school is near.	Because introduces the reason.
Result	The school is near, so I walk.	So introduces the result.
Two clauses	She is tired, but she finishes the task.	The second clause contrasts expectation.

Control agreement and noun form

The selected structure must still agree with its subject or noun. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Reason first	Because it is late, we go home.	A reason clause can open the sentence.
Addition clauses	He opens the book and he reads the first page.	And links two compatible actions.
Alternative action	We can walk or take the bus.	Or joins two choices.

Use the pattern in real interaction

Short exchanges reveal whether the structure sounds complete and purposeful. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Cause-result chain	It is raining, so the match stops.	Rain causes the result.
Contrast negative	I like coffee, but I do not drink it at night.	But marks the limitation.
Reason answer	Why are you late? Because the bus is slow.	Because answers why.

Compare nearby forms

Similar-looking alternatives are not interchangeable when polarity, logic or position changes. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Contrast	The café is small, but it is comfortable.	But contrasts size and comfort.
Choice	Do you want tea or coffee?	Or presents alternatives.
Reason	I walk because the school is near.	Because introduces the reason.

Repair the Spanish transfer

The English frame may encode the same idea with a different operator, determiner or word order. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Result	The school is near, so I walk.	So introduces the result.
Two clauses	She is tired, but she finishes the task.	The second clause contrasts expectation.
Reason first	Because it is late, we go home.	A reason clause can open the sentence.

Connect two decisions

A natural sentence often combines form, meaning and reference rather than testing one blank in isolation. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Addition clauses	He opens the book and he reads the first page.	And links two compatible actions.
Alternative action	We can walk or take the bus.	Or joins two choices.
Cause-result chain	It is raining, so the match stops.	Rain causes the result.

Run the final audit

Before approving the sentence, reconstruct the intended meaning and check every visible dependency. Start from meaning, then locate the grammatical slot that carries that meaning. This keeps the sentence understandable and avoids a word-for-word transfer from Spanish.

Compare the complete examples rather than memorising an isolated word. The surrounding subject, verb, noun type and communicative purpose explain why the selected form is appropriate.

Context	Model	Control
Addition	Nora studies English and French.	And adds a second item.
Contrast	The café is small, but it is comfortable.	But contrasts size and comfort.
Choice	Do you want tea or coffee?	Or presents alternatives.

From controlled form to real A1 communication

A learner controls Basic connectors only when the form survives outside a single model sentence. Begin with the central contrast, rebuild it with a new subject and new vocabulary, and then place it inside a short exchange. The structure should remain accurate while the communicative details change.

Use a three-part review. First, name the intended meaning. Second, point to the word or position that carries that meaning. Third, read the whole sentence and check whether reference, agreement and register still fit the situation. This review turns a correct answer into a reusable A1 skill.

Do not judge the target form in isolation. Read the words immediately before and after it, identify the subject and the finite verb, and reconstruct the positive or neutral sentence when useful. This local context often explains an ending, an auxiliary, a determiner or a position that would otherwise seem arbitrary.

For independent study, complete one short stage at a time and record the reason for every correction. A useful note has three parts: the form you wrote, the form the sentence requires and the decision that separates them. Revisit that decision with a new example within twenty-four hours, then read both examples aloud and compare their rhythm with confidence.

Stage	Action	Success evidence
Recognise	identify the target decision	explains the meaning
Rebuild	change subject or vocabulary	keeps the pattern
Use	place it in a mini-dialogue	sounds complete
Review	correct and explain	names the controlling rule

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

idea 1 -> logical relationship -> connector -> idea 2

Decide en este orden

1. Read both ideas.
2. Name the relationship.
3. Choose and for addition.
4. Choose but for contrast.
5. Choose or for alternatives.
6. Choose because before a reason.
7. Choose so before a result.
8. Read the chain for logic and punctuation.

Decision	Pattern	Example
Addition	and	Nora studies English and French.
Contrast	but	The café is small, but it is comfortable.
Choice	or	Do you want tea or coffee?
Reason	because	I walk because the school is near.
Result	so	The school is near, so I walk.
Two clauses	but	She is tired, but she finishes the task.
Reason first	Because	Because it is late, we go home.
Addition clauses	and	He opens the book and he reads the first page.
Alternative action	or	We can walk or take the bus.

Errores frecuentes

× I stay home because it is raining, so··· must keep reason and result distinct.

× Because I am tired so I sleep. -> Because I am tired, I sleep. / I am tired, so I sleep.

× I like tea but coffee. -> I like tea and coffee / tea but not coffee.

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

Nora studies English and French.	And adds a second item.
The café is small, but it is comfortable.	But contrasts size and comfort.
Do you want tea or coffee?	Or presents alternatives.
I walk because the school is near.	Because introduces the reason.
The school is near, so I walk.	So introduces the result.
She is tired, but she finishes the task.	The second clause contrasts expectation.
Because it is late, we go home.	A reason clause can open the sentence.
He opens the book and he reads the first page.	And links two compatible actions.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

24 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

A · Recognise the pattern

1. Nora studies English ___ French. Opciones: and · but · because · so

2. The café is small, ___ it is comfortable. Opciones: but · and · because · or

3. Do you want tea ___ coffee? Opciones: or · and · so · because

4. I walk ___ the school is near. Opciones: because · so · but · or

5. The school is near, ___ I walk. Opciones: so · because · but · or

6. She is tired, ___ she finishes the task. Opciones: but · and · because · so

7. ___ it is late, we go home. Opciones: Because · So · But · Or

8. He opens the book ___ he reads the first page. Opciones: and · or · because · but

9. We can walk ___ take the bus. Opciones: or · and · so · because

10. It is raining, ___ the match stops. Opciones: so · because · and · or

11. I like coffee, ___ I do not drink it at night. Opciones: but · and · so · because

12. Why are you late? ___ the bus is slow. Opciones: Because · So · And · Or

B · Connect two decisions

13. Nora studies English _____ French. The café is small, _____ it is comfortable. Opciones: and · but · because · so / but · and · because · or

14. Do you want tea _____ coffee? I walk _____ the school is near. Opciones: or · and · so · because / because · so · but · or

15. The school is near, _____ I walk. She is tired, _____ she finishes the task. Opciones: so · because · but · or / but · and · because · so

16. _____ it is late, we go home. He opens the book _____ he reads the first page. Opciones: Because · So · But · Or / and · or · because · but

17. We can walk _____ take the bus. It is raining, _____ the match stops. Opciones: or · and · so · because / so · because · and · or

C · Read a connected text

18. Nora studies English _____ French. The café is small, _____ it is comfortable. Do you want tea _____ coffee? I walk _____ the school is near. The school is near, _____ I walk. She is tired, _____ she finishes the task. _____ it is late, we go home. He opens the book _____ he reads the first page.

D · Retrieve without options

19. _____ it is late, we go home. He opens the book _____ he reads the first page. We can walk _____ take the bus. It is raining, _____ the match stops. I like coffee, _____ I do not drink it at night. Why are you late? _____ the bus is slow.

E · Produce in context

20. Write four sentences that demonstrate the main contrast in Basic connectors.

_____

21. Write a four-line everyday dialogue using at least three forms from Basic connectors.

_____

22. Choose two common errors from this lesson, correct them and explain the rule.

_____

F · Final mission

23. Write 80-110 words about a realistic A1 situation. Use at least eight target forms from Basic connectors, include one question, one negative and one short exchange, and finish with a two-point self-check.

_____

24. Choose two sentences from your mission. For each one, name the Basic connectors decision and explain why the selected form fits.

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. and — And adds a second item.
2. but — But contrasts size and comfort.
3. or — Or presents alternatives.
4. because — Because introduces the reason.
5. so — So introduces the result.
6. but — The second clause contrasts expectation.
7. Because — A reason clause can open the sentence.
8. and — And links two compatible actions.
9. or — Or joins two choices.
10. so — Rain causes the result.
11. but — But marks the limitation.
12. Because — Because answers why.
13. and / but — And adds a second item. But contrasts size and comfort.
14. or / because — Or presents alternatives. Because introduces the reason.
15. so / but — So introduces the result. The second clause contrasts expectation.
16. Because / and — A reason clause can open the sentence. And links two compatible actions.
17. or / so — Or joins two choices. Rain causes the result.
18. and / but / or / because / so / but / Because / and — And adds a second item. But contrasts size and comfort. Or presents alternatives. Because introduces the reason. So introduces the result. The second clause contrasts expectation. A reason clause can open the sentence. And links two compatible actions.
19. Because / and / or / so / but / Because — A reason clause can open the sentence. And links two compatible actions. Or joins two choices. Rain causes the result. But marks the limitation. Because answers why.
20. Nora studies English and French. The café is small, but it is comfortable. Do you want tea or coffee? I walk because the school is near. — Each sentence realises a different controlled decision.
21. The school is near, so I walk. She is tired, but she finishes the task. Because it is late, we go home. He opens the book and he reads the first page. — The forms appear inside a connected exchange.
22. I stay home because it is raining, so··· must keep reason and result distinct. Because I am tired so I sleep. -> Because I am tired, I sleep. / I am tired, so I sleep. — The response links correction to a reusable rule.
23. Nora studies English and French. The café is small, but it is comfortable. Do you want tea or coffee? I walk because the school is near. The school is near, so I walk. She is tired, but she finishes the task. Because it is late, we go home. He opens the book and he reads the first page. I check the subject and verb first. I also check the meaning and position of every target form. — The mission integrates form, meaning, question structure and self-correction.
24. Nora studies English and French. And adds a second item. The café is small, but it is comfortable. But contrasts size and comfort. — The audit makes the learner connect a produced form with its controlling decision.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.

Retrieval

Review focus	Retrieval	Feedback
Add information with and	Explain and exemplify: Add information with and.	Read both ideas.
Contrast with but	Explain and exemplify: Contrast with but.	Name the relationship.
Offer alternatives with or	Explain and exemplify: Offer alternatives with or.	Choose and for addition.

Review focus	Retrieval	Feedback
Distinguish reason because from result so	Explain and exemplify: Distinguish reason because from result so.	Choose but for contrast.